

Hazrat Ayoob عليه السلام

Hazrat Ayoob عليه السلام in the Qur'ān

In the Qur'ān Hazrat Ayoob عليه السلام is mentioned in four Surahs:

- (a) "And we sent inspiration in Abraham عليه السلام, Ismail عليه السلام, Ishaq عليه السلام, Yaqoob عليه السلام and the tribes, to Esa عليه السلام, Ayoob عليه السلام, Yunus عليه السلام, Haroon عليه السلام and Sulaiman عليه السلام." (4:163)

- (b) "We guided Nooh عليه السلام before him. And among His progeny, Dawood عليه السلام, Sulaiman عليه السلام, Ayoob عليه السلام, Yusuf عليه السلام, Musa عليه السلام and Haroon عليه السلام." (6:84)

- (c) "And remember Ayyob عليه السلام when he cried to his lord: "Truly distress has seized me, But You are the Most Merciful of those that are merciful.

So we listened to him. We removed the distress that was on him. And we restored his people to him and doubled their number—as a grace from ourselves and a thing for commemoration, for all who serve us."

(21: 83—89)

- (d) "Commemorate our servant Ayoob عليه السلام. Behold he cried to his Lord: "The evil one has affected me with distress and suffering."

(The command was given) "Strike with your foot. Here is (water) wherein to wash, loof and refreshing and (water) to drink."

And We gave him back his people and doubled their number—as a Grace from Ourselves and a thing for commemoration for all who have understanding.

"And take in your hand a little grass and strike therewith and break not your oath." Truly We found him full of patience and constancy.

How excellent in our service, ever did he turn to us."

(38:41—44)

In these verses the story of Nabi Ayooob ؑ is told in very concise terms but in spite of the shortened version, still in eloquent manner the major points have been mentioned, and in correct manner as is not even found in the lengthy story told in the Book of Job.

Nabi Ayooob ؑ was a saintly person who used to be among the prophets and messengers of Allah. The Qur'ān says: "Remember our Servant." He used to be a wealthy person with many children who used to be very fortunate and happy.

Suddenly he was involved in a great trial and test and to come into distress in his possessions, his family and was in affliction in his body as well. His possessions became destroyed. His family perished and his body was stuck by disease. Even then too he did not complain, but bore it all with patience. He only cried to Allah: "The evil one has struck me with distress and suffering."

His respectful manner was such that he did not say: "O Allah, you have struck me with distress and suffering." He knew that although Allah is the real Doer in this world, yet disress and punishment comes as a result of *Shaitani* causes,

for this reason he says that *Shaitan* had touched him with distress and suffering. Then also in a very graceful and eloquent manner says: "*Anne Mussaniyod dur*" viz: "Affliction and suffering has touched me all round. And you are the Most Merciful one of all Merciful ones.

And when he called on Allah, Allah heard his plea and answered him. The result was that the possessions that was lost, was returned to him and the family that perished was soon replaced. For his health, a special fountain was opened up that he may wash therein and be healed: He was addressed:

"Strike with your feet. Here is water wherein to wash, cool and refreshing and water to drink.

And we gave him back his people and doubled their numbers."

And all this was done as a sign of Allah's mercy to him, and so that obedient once may take a lesson from therefrom.

Then also Allah praises Ayoob عليه السلام patience and his piety by saying:

"Truly we found him full of patience and constancy. How excellent in our service, ever did he turn to us."

A Few Points of Tafseer

1. The Stricktness of Nabi Ayoob عليه السلام

In the Israeli *Riwaayaat* there was are some exaggerated reports regarding the sickness suffered by Hazrat Ayoob عليه السلام. Some such kinds of sicknesses are mentioned which lead to people having aversion to them so that one tries to avoid meeting one with such sickness.

Islāmic scholars state that in view of the Qur'ān and *Hadith* not mentioning any specific diseases, and no details, it is useless to discuss those Israeli *Riwaayaat*.

Meaning of 'Massaniyas Shaitan'

2. According to the Qur'ān Nabi Ayoob ؑ was to have said: "O Lord, the *Shaitan* has touched me with distress and suffering."

Islāmic scholars state that Hazrat Ayoob ؑ uttered these words in this manner as a mark of respect. His meaning was not that he admitted that *Shaitan* had control of his body.

From Allah's side what emanates is good. And what we look upon as being bad is only bad according to our opinions because if we should consider that thing in relation to the whole affairs of this world, we are forced to consider it also as good. Our own relationships and the relationship of our deeds make some things as bad, but in reality those very things are good.

3. The Qur'ān says: "And we gave back to him his people and doubled their number." In this verse it speaks of his people being returned to Hazrat Ayoob ؑ. What is the meaning of that? Does it mean that after the restoration of his health Allah granted him an increase of off-spring more than what he had before that? Or does it mean that his family which had become dispersed all over were gain gathered in one place? Or does it mean that those who had already died were given new life and increased? Ibn Kathir in his *Tafseer* quoted Hasan and Qatada who explained that to have been the case. This is also the view Shah Abdul Qadir, Imam Razi and Ibn Hibban are inclined towards the first opinion that after his health was restored, Allah granted him in the place of his perished family, other off-spring even more

than before. The verses of the Qur'ān hold within it the possibility of both meanings.

4. In *Surah Saud* we have the verse:

"And take in your hand a little grass and strike therewith and break not your oath."

In this a reference to a special incident? The Qur'ān and *Hadith* make no mention of any details. However the *Mufasssireen* says that after all kinds of calamity had struck Hazrat Ayoob عليه السلام and when there was no one else to show any sympathy to him, his pious wife was the only one who looked after him. It so happened that on one occasion, having become so heavily affected by Hazrat Ayoob (*Alaihis Salām*)'s affliction she uttered such words which could be taken to be in contrast to Nabi Ayoob (*Alaihis Salām*)'s patience and appeared like a complaint towards Allah. Nabi Ayoob عليه السلام could not bear this and he swore an oath that he would strike her a hundred blows. When the time for his trial and affliction was expired and his health restored, the question arose as to the fulfilling of the oath which he swore. On the one side was his life-partner and her faithfulness, sympathy and good treatment and on the other side was the question of fulfilling an oath which he had sworn. He was in quite a bit of doubt and hesitation. Then Allah showed him a way out of his predicament, that he should take a hundred Salas of grass, make them into a bundle and then strike her a blow with it. That would fulfill the oath.

5. In *Surah Saud* also we have the verse: "Strike with your foot. Here is (water) wherein to wash, cool and freshing and (water) to drink."

Regarding this verse Ibn Katheer has written the following:

"Allah ordered Hazrat Ayoob ؑ to get up and strike his feet against the ground. When Hazrat Ayoob ؑ did that, He opened up a fountain from the earth with water flowing from it. He washed in it and all the external disease of his body disappeared. Then he again struck his feet against the ground and another fountain opened up. He drank of its water and his internal disease disappeared. Being restored to health he praised and thanked Allah."

Hafiz Ibn Hajar also quoted something similar on the authority of Ibn Jareen Qautada.

Whether there was one fountain or two does not really matter. What matters is that Allah chose a natural way to bring back health to Hazrat Ayoob ؑ. Even these days there are certain fountains with natural mineral waters which are used for health.

And if one washes in those waters or drinks thereof, the sickness either becomes lessened or cured. Here however the fountain opened up in a miraculous way.

Other Incidents

Imam Bukhari reports that Rasulullah ﷺ said:

"While Nabi Ayoob ؑ was once taking a bath Allah sent down upon him a number of golden locusts. Nabi Ayoob ؑ saw them and took a heedful and bid them in a piece of cloth. Then Allah called out to him:

"O Ayoob ؑ did we not grant you everything and made you prosperous and rich? What is this?

Ayoob ؑ replied: "O Lord, It is true that you have made me rich. But Lord when can a man

say he is not in need of your bounties and blessings? No one is so rich that he is not in need of your blessings?"

In expanding on the meaning of this *Hadith*, Hafiz Ibn Hajar says that Imam Bukhari in accordance with his condition is of authenticity has mentioned this *Hadith* without trying to establish any other *Mas'ala* from it. Ibn Hajar from his one side reports the *Hadith* to be completely authentic.

Hazrat Anas رضي الله عنه reports that Nabi Ayoob عليه السلام was afflicted with those calamities for a period of thirteen years until such a time when all his relation and friends chose to avoid contact with him. Only two of his relative used to continue to visit him. One day one of them said to the other. "It seems as if Ayoob عليه السلام must have been guilty of a very big sin, for which he is being punished with this affliction. If it is not so then Allah would have shown mercy to him and have restored his health."

The other one related this story to Nabi Ayoob عليه السلام; and it caused him great anguish and distress. He immediately fell into *Sajdah* and prayed to Allah. Thereafter he rose from his place to proceed towards where he was to relieve himself. His wife took his hand and led him. Soon thereafter the order came from Allah to strike his foot against the ground and a fountain opened up with water gushing forth. He performed ghoust and immediately appeared much better as for as health was concerned. His wife was still awaiting his return and when he came forth she could not recognise him and in fact questioned him about Ayoob عليه السلام. Then he said to her: "I am Ayoob." He then related the rest of the story to her as to what happened. It is said that for his daily needs there used to be near him a small bag with wheat in it and a bag with

barley. Allah so increased his wealth that the bag with wheat became a bag of gold and the bag of barley was changed into a bag with silver.

A similar report more or less is reported by Ibn Abi Haatim from Hazrat Abdullah bin Abbaas ؓ. Sayeduna Wahab bin Munabbah relates that the period of affliction was three years where as Hasan reports it to have been seven years.

Lessons and Warnings

1. Among the certain of Allah those who are nearest to Him are being tested and tried in the harshest ways. And if they show patience and steadfastness during the trial, that test become for them a means towards gaining high ranks. Rasulullah ﷺ explained this in the following way: "As far as calamities are concerned the people tested in the hardest manner are the prophets. Thereafter the saintly pious ones and thereafter according to their ranks." (Hadith)

"A man is being tested in connection the ranks of his *Deen*. Thus if in his *Deen* there is firmness and steadfastness in his *Deen* then the test too will be more severe." (Hadith)

2. When a person has a high position of honour, has riches and wealth and is in a good position of well-being it is not difficult to express thanks and gratitude. And if there is no pride, arrogance and egotism, it is very easy to be grateful. But in the case of calamities and hardship, sorrow, poverty and obstacles to remain satisfied and contented with Allah's judgement on your behalf without any complaint and then still to be patient and steadfast, this is a difficult task. Therefore when any person in this different position does not

discard his steadfastness and continues to be patient, then Allah's special attribute of *Rahmat* (mercy) comes into operation and Allah's blessings and mercy begins to rain over him and he becomes endowed with such bounties as are unexpected, granting him worldly as well as spiritual favours. The life of Hazrat Ayoob عليه السلام is a living example of this.

"And remember Ayoob عليه السلام when he cried to his lord:

Truly distress has seized me, But You are the Most Merciful of those that are merciful.

So we listened to him and removed the distress that was on him. And we restored his people to him and doubled their number. As a grace from ourselves and a thing for commemoration for all who serve us." (21:83—84)

3. A man should never despair of the mercy of Allah, because hopelessness is a sign of *Kufr* and one should not believe that calamities are only a punishment for sins committed. Very often calamities comes along by way of tests and trials and for the patient and grateful one brings Allah's mercy. In one *Hadith Qudsi* Allah addresses His servants and says:

"I am near to the imagination of My servants."

(*Hadith*)

In other words: I am as My servants imagine Me to be in their hearts.

4. Between a husband and a wife the most desired thing is that there should be faithfulness and steadfastness. Thus in a *Hadith* the worst of whispering which *Shaitan* loves very much is to throw suspicion between husband and wife and to spread the seeds of hatred and enmity. Hence in the *Hadith* the good news

of entrance into paradise is given to that woman who remains pious towards her husband and faithful. This faithfulness and love is more appreciated when the husband becomes involved in obstacles and calamities which can be so bad that even friends and relations choose to desert him. For this reason the pious wife of Hazrat Ayoob ؑ had been faithful, sympathetic, obedient and stood by him in his difficult time. The result was that Allah gave Nabi Ayoob ؑ a novel way of carrying out his oath which he took to strike her one hundred blows. This incident is enough to indicate the great appreciation and high rank of a pious wife.

5. "And remember! Your Lord caused to be declared:

If you are grateful, I will add more favours unto you." (14:7)

"And give glad tidings to those who patiently persevere, who say when afflicted with calamity: To Allah we belong and to Him is our return. They are those on whom descend blessings from Allah and mercy. And they are the ones who receive guidance." (2:155)

QASASUL AMBIYAA

STORIES OF THE PROPHETS

Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Rah.)



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Qasasul Ambiyaa

(Stories of the Prophets)

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Qasasul Ambiyaa

The Holy Qur'ān does not relate historical facts merely for the sake of telling a story which is of historical value. Its main aim in relating happenings is to draw attention to the results, conclusions and deductions from these incidents so that they become a source of guidance for men and prove to be lessons for them that appeal to their minds and emotions that from these historical events, lessons should be derived. These lessons should convince them that the existence of Allah is an undeniable fact and that His Mighty Hand is playing a major role in the affairs of men. It should also bring to their notice that to follow the stipulations of His deen brings success and leads to salvation and is the way towards all progress. That is what Islām—the natural religion—is about.

From: Qasasul Qur'ān

Preface

The most authentic and comprehensive work of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy, *Qasasul Qur'ān* needs no introduction. However, the Manner in which our friend Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version of a voluminous and bulky work he has undoubtedly, fulfilled one of the needs of this time. He has adopted such a method of abridgement whereby not only has he retained and mentioned every important fact in the lives of the Holy Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and other saintly personalities, which are of lessons to men, but also discussed in brought outline some other important matters. It is hoped that with Allah's grace, those persons who are occupied and busy at all times, will be able to derive adequate benefit from this work.

The great effort of Sayed Tanzeem Hussain in this old age of his is really something praiseworthy. May Allah reward him well for this great effort.

Qari Sayed Rasheedul-Hasan Hussainy Nadwi

Imam and Khateeb

Jama Masjid, New Town

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P5 Muharram, 1308 Hijri

Publisher's Foreword

The respected personality of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy is one of the most eminent Ulama of the Indo-Pak Sub-Continent. His most approved and well-known book, *Qasasul-Qur'ān* is considered to be a unique publication on this subject. The point that distinguishes it from other similar books is the fact that after every story, Maulana has made use of deep thought and reflection to present to the readers the lessons and points of guidance from the related episodes. Thus for the teachers and lecturers at *Deeni Madressas* and for preachers in mosques and students of deen the study and perusal of this book is of utmost benefit.

The original book appeared in four volumes with over 1800 pages of subject matter. Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version there of in only 600 pages and this has been met with a verdict of approval from all academic circles, especially by virtue of the fact that he has fulfilled one of the most pressing needs of the time and by leaving aside unimportant discussions have given the busy and occupied ones also a chance to benefit from these work. May Allah reward him well.

Author's Foreword

All praise be to Allah who has guided us with the Holy Book and revealed to us the Qur'ān in a clear Arabic language and in it. He related the best of stories as an admonition and a reminder for the believers. And May peace and blessings be upon the Most truthful and trustworthy Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, the messenger of Allah and seal of all the Prophets and upon his offspring, and companions who were all of them guiding stars for all the righteous ones.

Among the inimitable ways in which Allah has chosen for the sake of the guidance of men, is this that attention is drawn to the good and bad deeds of nations and the resultant fruits of such deeds of which they are reminded so that those deeds may be a lesson for men. For this reason those stories are not being related in a style as is generally done in history. The major aim is to convey the truth and to invite to Allah and with this in mind attention is only drawn to those aspects which furthers this objective. For this reason there is constant repetition so that these events can sink into the hearts and minds of listeners and they become attentive towards them. This sinking in and attentiveness can only be achieved if the same event is repeated in various ways and styles whereby sleeping faculties are woken up.

The Qur'ānic stories and events deal mostly with previous nations and the Messengers of Allah (*Alaihimus*

Salām) who were sent to them and bit by bit other matters also become included there-in, mostly dealing with the arguments over good and bad and the battles between the friends of Allah and the friends of *Shaitan*, which in itself proves to be a great lesson and admonishment for me.

But, leaving others aside, there are today so few Muslims who derive benefit from Allah's last and perfect law-book, the Qur'ān, to fill our hearts with *Iman* and *Yaqeen*. After all it is Allah's law and we are commanded to implement its orders in our lives, Moreover we are required to ponder over its meanings as this Qur'ān is the means forwards acquiring success and salvation in both this world and the here after.

At the time of the Revelation of the Qur'ān, the Messenger of Allah became so distressed and defected at the enmity and opposition of the polytheists that he raised this complaint to Allah:

(5:25—30)

However, in this 15th century, if we should examine our hearts, we will find that in spite of our claims to be Muslims and believing the Qur'ān to be the word of Allah, how few are who have made this word of Allah the pattern for their lives and the model on which to base their lives, who read and recited with this aim in mind?

It was my aim, seeing this condition of my people and myself, to translate this great source of admonition into Urdu so that by presenting the translated version, the hearts of people will automatically become drawn to the original i.e., the Qur'ān and thereby acquire everlasting happiness.

In spite of my simple style of writing, care has been taken to confine myself to a few special points.

- (a) In this book the basis for all the stories is the Holy Qur'ān and the authentic *Hadith* and these have been further elucidated with historical facts.
- (b) Where there appears any contradiction or differences in the stories as told in the old testament and the Qur'ān, then with clear arguments an effort has been made either to reconcile the versions or with clear arguments to prove the truth as is expounded in the Qur'ān.
- (c) An effort has been made to point out the nonsensical Israili stories and where there have been nonsensical objections from enemies, these have in the light of the true facts been made clear for what they are.
- (d) In some special places there have been introduced some discussions on matters of disputes in *Tafseer* and *Hadith* and after discussing these the views of the saintly elders have been mentioned as a solution.
- (e) The facts concerning every Prophet ﷺ and in which chapter of the Qur'ān they are mentioned, has been gathered in one place.
- (f) Lastly, together with all the above points, a special heading of "Results and lessons", is introduced, giving the actual objective of this book and its main purpose viz., admonition and warning. Special attention is drawn to this aspect.

Servant of the Millat

Muhammad Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy

22 Rajab, 1360 Hijri

Translator's Foreword

For me as the translator of this book by Maulana Hifzur Rahman is a great honour. Throughout my student days in Darul Uloom Deoband in India, Maulana Hifzur Rahman or as we know him then as the *Mujahid-e-Millat* was one of the most respected leaders of the Muslim community. We used to flock to listen to his most interesting lectures. And as the general secretary of the *Jamiatul-Ulama*, and a M.P. he was also a great 'Alim (scholar) as can be gauged from this book *Qasasul Ambiya* (Tales of the Prophets) which entailed great research. I can remember whenever the students were confronted with any problem in the lives of any of the prophets, they always took refuge in Maulana's book for answers. I took upon it as a great honour in being in some small manner associated with Maulana's scholarship, even though this is an abridged version of the original book. But I must also state that I found great difficulty in translating this book because of the exceptionally high quality of the Urdu language used in the book.

I hope that the English translation of Maulana Hifzur Rahman's scholarly work will also be of great benefit to the English-speaking people. I just hope that I have been able to do justice to the original thoughts of the author.

Yusuf Karaan
Strand, South Africa